

Florian Strauf

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SUMMARY

Architect, software engineer, and former SAP employee with 20+ years of experience translating business needs into practical technology solutions. My background combines deep enterprise delivery experience with the last four years of hands-on work building products, leading teams, and working deeply with modern application stacks, data platforms, and AI-enabled systems. That recent experience keeps my advisory work grounded in the realities of how modern systems are scoped, built, integrated, and scaled. In parallel with product building, I have continued to advise businesses on solution direction, including ERP replacement scoping, build-vs-buy evaluation, effort estimation, architecture, and implementation planning.

AREAS OF EXPERTISE

- **Solution Architecture & Business Alignment:** Strong track record of translating business requirements into pragmatic solution designs, roadmaps, and delivery plans.
- **ERP Planning & Process Design:** Experience advising businesses on ERP direction, implementation planning, and aligning technology choices with operational needs.
- **Data, Analytics & AI Advisory:** Able to connect data platforms, analytics, and AI opportunities to concrete business outcomes and practical implementation steps.
- **Business and Technology Translation:** Combines deep technical expertise with strong business understanding, allowing me to work effectively with stakeholders, leadership teams, and delivery teams.
- **Technical Leadership & Delivery Enablement:** Proven ability to lead teams, improve development processes, and raise execution quality without losing speed.
- **AI & Modernization Opportunities:** Practical experience identifying where AI and automation can create real value inside products, workflows, and delivery teams.
- **Hands-On Technical Depth:** Credible across architecture and implementation, from enterprise integrations and backend systems to frontend applications, data pipelines, and analytics.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Principal Technical Advisor & Solution Advisor

Independent Consultant | March 2025 - Present

Partnering with businesses as a strategic technology advisor. My focus is on helping leadership teams turn business needs into clear technical direction, with an emphasis on solution planning, ERP thinking, architecture, and pragmatic execution.

Relevant Advisory Work:

- Worked with New Zealand Packing and Kiwifruit Management Company in a solution advisory capacity to help shape ERP planning and align business needs with a practical implementation path.
- Supported with ERP-related planning and solution thinking, helping translate operational requirements into clearer technical direction.

Founder & Builder at daystoexpiry.com

2025 - Present

Built and operate a niche SaaS product from concept to paying customers. The platform demonstrates current, hands-on capability across product design, systems architecture, data processing, analytics, and AI-assisted workflows.

The application ingests and parses broker statements, normalizes positions and trades, and presents them in a clear, options-focused view. On top of this, I implemented AI-driven analysis to help users evaluate and plan options income strategies based on their actual portfolio holdings.

Key User Benefits Delivered:

- **Automated Data Pipeline:** Imports, scans, and reconciles broker statements into a clean, structured dataset.
- **AI-Assisted Trade Discovery:** Surfaces covered call, put-selling, and other income opportunities aligned with users' holdings.
- **Clear Performance Insight:** Visualizes income, risk, and drawdowns in an intuitive, portfolio-centric dashboard.
- **Actionable Strategy Guidance:** Bridges the gap from "what do I hold?" to "what should I do next?" with portfolio-aware suggestions.

Founder & Builder at [Expensesorted.com](https://expensesorted.com)

2023 - Present

Founded and continue to build a personal finance product designed around user control, privacy, and automation. This work keeps my technical skills current across modern full-stack development, data-driven workflows, AI-supported automation, and user-focused product design.

Key User Benefits Delivered:

- **Provides Complete Control & Privacy:** Gives users peace of mind by using their own Google Sheet as the database.
- **Saves Hours of Manual Effort:** Eliminates the need for manual data entry by automatically importing and categorizing bank transactions with an intelligent, AI-powered engine.
- **Offers Clear Financial Insight:** Helps users instantly understand where their money goes with an intuitive, visual dashboard.
- **Delivers Actionable Guidance:** Offers personalized, AI-driven suggestions and financial modeling to help users make smarter decisions.

CTO at Forgd.com

Jan 2024 - March 2025

Led the technical vision and delivery of Forgd.com, a platform serving blockchain builders, with responsibility spanning architecture, delivery, and team leadership.

Key Achievements:

- Built and scaled a robust platform from concept to over 1000 users in under 12 months.
- Grew and led a technical team from 4 to 14 developers while maintaining high-velocity.
- Implemented structured development processes with clear project phases and estimates.
- Architected and built complex data systems, including economic modeling algorithms in Python and big data integrations.

Founder & CEO at Tokenomics DAO (acquired by Forgd.com)

2021 - 2024

Founded and led a consulting-led community business focused on tokenomics and strategic design for web3 projects.

Key Achievements:

- Built a community of 3,000+ members.
- Scaled a consulting business to 10+ contributors serving 15+ clients.
- Developed a industry focused token launch SaaS for modelling supply demand curves of token launches
- Successfully merged the business with Forgd.com.

Solution Architect at SAP

2014 - 2021

Progressed through multiple roles at SAP, from Senior Consultant in Innovation to Solution Architect for Asset Intensive Industries and Innovation Centre Network Public Blockchain. Delivered complex enterprise solutions across multiple industries while leading innovation initiatives at board level.

Key Achievements:

- **Blockchain & Innovation Leadership (2021):** Created decentralized business strategy for SAP's adoption of emerging web3 technology. Delivered board-level proposals on crypto payments, token-based revenue streams, and making the SAP portfolio web3-ready. Evaluated token-based revenue streams to monetize beyond traditional license revenue. Led supply chain carbon use cases across German automotive industry and shaped decision-making on SAP's engagement in Catena-X and Gaia-X ecosystems.
- **Asset Intensive Industries (2020-2021):** Solution architecture for Asset Intensive Industries as part of SAP Centre of Excellence. Drove feature and roadmap planning for product extensions. Developed GTM strategy as subject matter expert for Intelligent Asset Management (IAM).
- **Innovative Business Solutions (2018-2020):** Solution architecture for IBSO proposals. Developed Go-To-Market approaches for new markets/products, presenting at industry events. Supported presales in translating customer requirements into technology solutions. Acted as trusted advisor on innovation topics.
- **Applied Technology Innovation (2014-2018):** Led delivery teams for innovation projects, proof of concepts, and pilots transitioning to productive implementations. Provided technical sales support for intelligent asset management products. Served as service owner for IoT products (Connected Goods, Vehicle Insights). Built IoT Map applications integrating with ESRI, Leaflet, HERE Maps, and OpenStreetMap.
- **Delivery Excellence:** Successfully led cloud customers out of escalation by analyzing and improving system performance. Safeguarded innovation projects as trusted advisor.
- **Recognition:** SAP Catalyst / Fast Track awards: 2016, 2017, 2018, 2019.

Development Consultant at SER Solutions Deutschland GmbH

2005 - 2014

Progressed from apprentice to Development Consultant, specializing in SAP ABAP development, workflow architecture, and enterprise content management integrations.

Key Achievements:

- **SAP FI/MM Invoice Processing (2012-2014):** Architected and developed FI/MM Invoice processing workflow solutions. Delivered UX development with SAP Fiori, SAPUI5, and OData services. Built Web Dynpro ABAP and NetWeaver Portal solutions. Developed ABAP Object-Oriented solutions and SAP Business Workflow implementations.
- **Product Management / Quality Management (2008-2012):** Led internal consulting projects on J2EE application servers (JBoss, IBM WebSphere). Managed migration of existing customers to latest product generation.

- **Apprenticeship (2005-2008):** Completed apprenticeship as Development Consultant with project development across .NET, Java, and Visual Basic.

EDUCATION

- **Bachelor of Science (B.Sc.),** FOM University of Applied Sciences for Economics and Management, Köln/Bonn, Germany (2014)
- **Apprenticeship as Development Consultant,** IHK Germany (2008)

ADDITIONAL ACTIVITIES

- **Writing:** Over 2,300 readers follow my writing at [LearnedLate](#).